

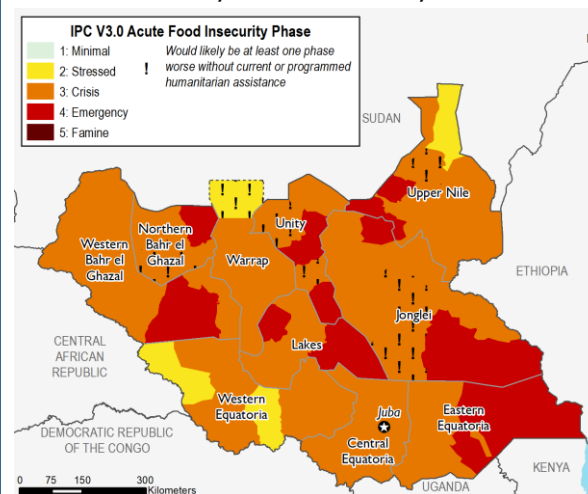
Widespread Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse outcomes and risk of Famine (IPC Phase 5) to persist in 2019

FEWS NET produces forward-looking food security analysis and IPC compatible mapping several times a year for 26 countries, including South Sudan. FEWS NET is a member of South Sudan's multi-stakeholder IPC Technical Working Group and an active participant in national IPC analysis workshops in South Sudan. The map and classifications in this report use IPC standards and methods, but do not necessarily reflect a consensus view of the national IPC Technical Working Group, IPC partners, or the Government of the Republic of South Sudan. However, this report was reviewed by the South Sudan IPC Technical Working Group prior to publication. The most recent national IPC analysis was conducted in January 2019.

KEY MESSAGES

- Extreme levels of acute food insecurity persist across South Sudan during the 2018/19 post-harvest period. Based on the [January 2019 IPC analysis](#), 6.17 million people were in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse in January. This estimate was in the presence of humanitarian food assistance and included roughly 30,000 people in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5).¹
- Conflict has declined somewhat since mid-2018, and staple food prices have declined slightly in several areas. Despite these improvements, conflict and very poor macroeconomic conditions still exist and are expected to persist throughout the projection period. Furthermore, many households still face extreme difficulty meeting their basic food needs as the protracted conflict has significantly disrupted livelihoods and eroded households' coping capacity.
- Food security is expected to deteriorate through the July/August peak of the lean season. Although humanitarian food assistance is anticipated to scale up during the lean season and will likely prevent more catastrophic outcomes, past trends indicate that the severity of food insecurity still increases during the lean season relative to the harvest period despite the increase in humanitarian food assistance. Widespread Crisis (IPC Phase 3) and Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are anticipated, and some households are likely to be in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5). Jonglei, Lakes, and Upper Nile States are of greatest concern, though concern still remains high for Unity, Western Bahr el Ghazal, and Greater Kapoeta. The total population in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse is expected to increase to an estimated 7.7 million people between May and July/August, in the absence of humanitarian food assistance.
- A risk of Famine (IPC Phase 5) will persist in South Sudan. Past trends indicate that food security can deteriorate sharply when conflict shifts and severely limits household movement and humanitarian access. Should this worst-case scenario occur, Famine (IPC Phase 5) would be likely. In order to sustain long-term food security improvements and end the persistent risk of Famine (IPC Phase 5) in South Sudan, full implementation of the September 2018 peace deal and an end to the conflict by all parties is needed.

Current food security outcomes, February 2019



Source: FEWS NET

FEWS NET classification is IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners.

¹ According to the IPC, a Famine (IPC Phase 5) has occurred when at least 20 percent of households in a given area have an extreme lack of food, the Global Acute Malnutrition (GAM) prevalence, as measured by weight-for-height z-score (WHZ), exceeds 30 percent, and mortality, as measured by the Crude Death Rate (CDR), is greater than 2 per 10,000 per day. Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) is when a household group has an extreme lack of food and/or other basic needs even with the full employment of coping strategies.

7.7 million people in need of food assistance during the peak of the 2019 lean season, and a risk of Famine (IPC Phase 5) will persist

Recent data on food consumption (Figure 1), nutrition, and mortality indicates that outcomes during the 2018/19 post-harvest period remain severe, with widespread areas in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse. In January, the IPC Technical Working Group [estimated 6.17 million people](#) (54% of the population) were in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse, of whom 1.36 million were in Emergency (IPC Phase 4), and 30,000 in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5). These estimates are in the presence of humanitarian food assistance delivery.

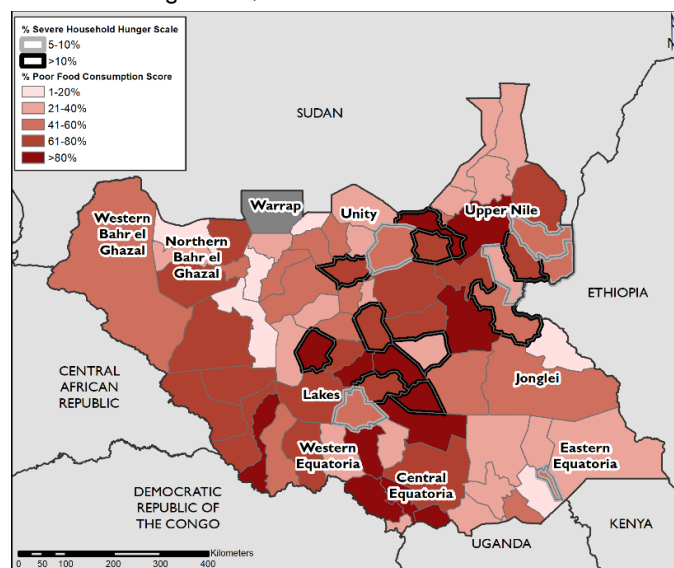
Conflict has decreased somewhat in late 2018 and early 2019 relative to the past three years and it is expected that conflict will continue in 2019 at current, relatively lower levels. This will lead to gradual improvements; however, some level of conflict is still likely, as are very poor macroeconomic conditions. Furthermore, the protracted conflict for over five years has eroded households' typical livelihoods and capacity to meet their basic food needs.

As a result, food security is expected to deteriorate during 2019 lean season and an estimated 7.7 million people will be in need of food assistance between May and July/August². Humanitarian food assistance (HFA) through general food distributions (GFD) and targeted food for assets (FFA) programs is planned to scale up during the lean season and reach 3-4 million people a month, though the actual reach of assistance is anticipated to be somewhat lower due to periodic access and budgetary constraints. The planned HFA is expected to prevent more extreme and even catastrophic outcomes; however, historical trends indicate that the severity of hunger still increases during the lean season relative to the post-harvest period despite the scale-up of HFA (Figure 2).

Extreme outcomes, including households in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5), are expected throughout the 2019 lean season even in the presence of planned, seasonally high levels of HFA. The number of planned beneficiaries is far below the need; HFA well above planned and funded levels, and unhindered humanitarian access, is needed throughout the projection period to prevent the loss of lives and further erosion of livelihoods.

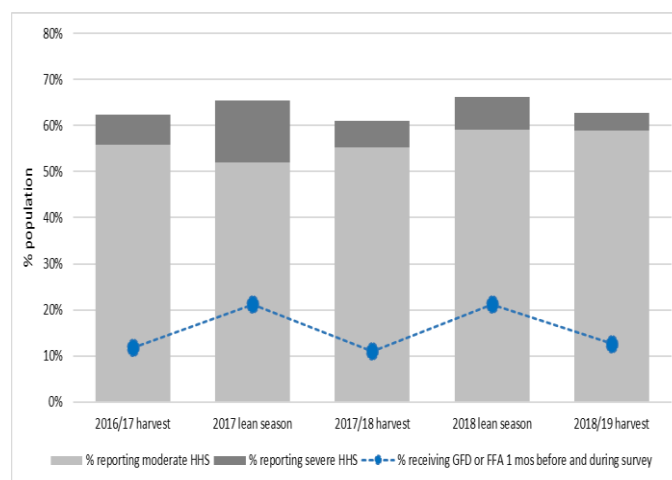
Past trends also indicate that conflict can shift quickly in South Sudan and food security deteriorates sharply when conflict restricts household movement and humanitarian access. Should this worst-case scenario occur, Famine (IPC Phase 5) would be likely. Full implementation of the September 2018 peace deal and an end to the conflict by all parties is needed to lead to long-term food security improvements and end the persistent risk of Famine (IPC Phase 5) in South Sudan.

Figure 1. Reporting of Poor Food Consumption Score and Severe Household Hunger Scale, 2018/19 harvest



Source: FSNMS Round 23 data

Figure 2. Percentage of the population reporting severe hunger across seasons versus percentage receiving GFD or FFA food assistance from WFP



Source: FSNMS data Rounds 19-23; WFP distribution reports

² The projection of 7.7 million people in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse is in a scenario that assumes the absence of planned humanitarian food assistance.

NATIONAL OVERVIEW

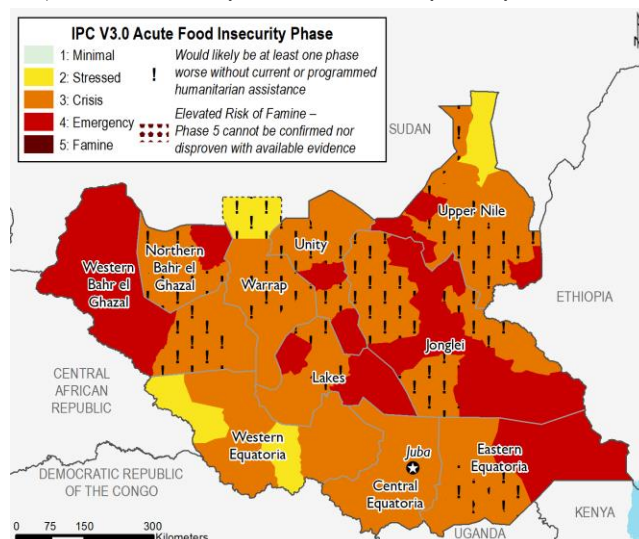
Current Situation

Extreme levels of acute food insecurity persist across South Sudan during the 2018/19 post-harvest period and outcomes are expected to further deteriorate through the July/August peak of the lean season, despite the scale-up of humanitarian food assistance during the lean season. According to the [January 2019 IPC analysis](#), an estimated 6.17 million people were in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse in January, 1.36 million of whom were in Emergency (IPC Phase 4), and 30,000 of whom were in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) in Canal/Pigi and Pibor of Jonglei, Panyikang of Upper Nile, and Cueibet of Lakes. The population in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse was in the presence of ongoing humanitarian food assistance (HFA). By July/August, it is expected the total population in need of food assistance will be 7.7 million people. Crisis (IPC Phase 3) and Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes will persist, and some households are likely to be in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5).

Since the signing of the September 2018 peace deal and subsequent efforts for ending hostilities, the number of reported conflict incidents has decreased in Greater Upper Nile and Greater Bahr el Ghazal. However, conflict still persists in South Sudan, most notably in parts of Greater Equatoria (Figure 3). Conflict in Yei, Morobo, Maridi, and Mundri is of high concern, posing further constraints to trade flows along the Kaya-Yei and Juba-Mundri-Maridi roads and limiting access to farmlands. Recent conflict in these areas has resulted in the displacement of an estimated [5,000 people](#) to Democratic Republic of Congo and 8,000 people to Yei Town. As of January 2019, an estimated [4.1 million people](#) remain displaced internally or in neighboring countries. In addition to displacing households, conflict continues to disrupt trade flows, the recovery of markets, free household movement, and engagement in typical livelihood activities. Although official tracking of returnees is not available, an estimated 12,000 people returned to Fashoda from Sudan, and over 8,200 people returned to their places of origin within Unity, though it is expected ongoing conflict is preventing further returnees.

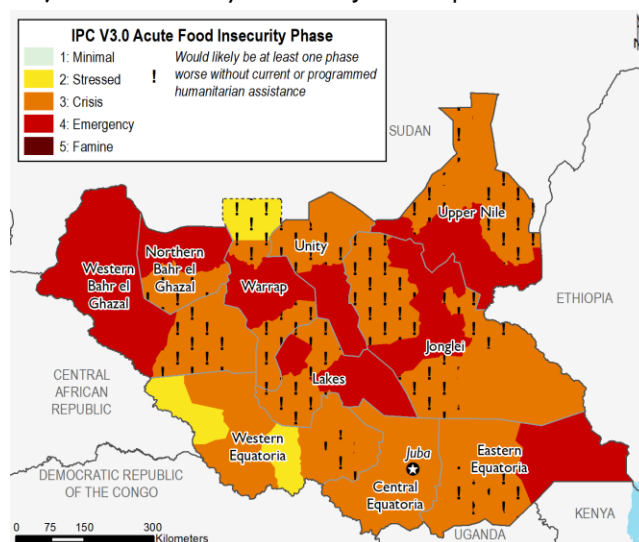
Throughout the country, insecurity-related disruptions to cultivation negatively affected households' capacity to cultivate crops in 2018, similar to the past five years. Furthermore, prolonged dry spells in 2018 in many counties and some pest infestations negatively impacted crop development, as corroborated by ground information and, for the former, remote-sensing imagery (Figure 4). Overall, 2018/19 harvests are estimated to be below pre-crisis levels and many counties are facing large cereal gaps: according to the 2018 FAO preliminary crop monitoring data, national cereal harvests are estimated to cover only 52 percent of the population's cereal needs. Data from the 23rd Round of the Food Security and Nutrition Monitoring System (FSNMS), collected between December 2018 and January 2019, indicated that approximately 57 percent of households harvested 1-4 months of food stocks. This is expected to be similar to last year's harvest, though well below the estimated 7 months of stocks that agricultural and agropastoral households typically harvested prior to the outbreak of conflict in 2013.

Projected food security outcomes, February to May 2019



Source: FEWS NET

Projected food security outcomes, June to September 2019



Source: FEWS NET

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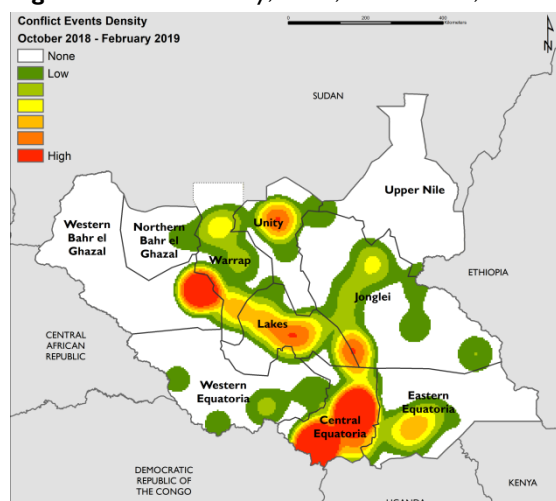
Macroeconomic conditions remain very poor and similar to last year, despite the recent increase in crude oil production from 130,000 barrels per day (b/d) in early 2018 to [165,000](#) b/d in January 2019. Total crude oil production is still 43 percent lower than 2011 and 21 percent lower than 2013. The South Sudanese Pound (SSP) has continued to depreciate from mid-2018, following the sharp appreciation observed at that time. However, the rate of depreciation is slower than that observed from 2015-2017 due to the gradual increase in oil production, which is increasing foreign currency earnings and reducing import inflation. In mid-February, the parallel exchange rate stood around 260 SSP/USD. The depreciation continues to drive extremely high food prices.

An analysis of cross-border trade data indicates that trade flows from Sudan and Uganda remain lower than pre-crisis levels due to conflict, high cost of transportation, and low purchasing power in South Sudan. Sorghum imports from Sudan are 63 percent lower than the same quarter last year and 99 percent lower than the five-year average, driven by the macroeconomic crisis in Sudan. Given this, it is expected northern markets are experiencing intermittent supply shortages. Conversely, maize imports from Uganda increased 167 percent compared to the five-year average, respectively. Based on a rapid market assessment conducted by FEWS NET in Juba in January, increased imports are due primarily to the expansion of staple food businesses in Juba following the peace deal. The Nimule-Juba road remains passable, though conflict in several areas of Central and Western Equatoria continue to disrupt normal trade flows through Kaya.

In the state capitals, markets continue to operate nearly at near normal levels (Figure 5), though with lower supply and reduced effective demand than pre-crisis years due to persistently high prices. In February, based on price data from [CLIMIS](#), a kilogram of white sorghum in Juba market is 90 percent lower than same time last year, but 203 percent higher than the five-year average. In Wau, the price of sorghum is 200 percent higher than same time last year and 581 percent higher than average. Overall, staple food prices have declined somewhat in recent months and are now lower than last year in Juba, though they remain above last year in markets outside of Juba and well above average in all markets (Figure 6). As a result of high prices, purchasing capacity remains low. In Juba, a day's wage of around 1,300 SSP can buy roughly 12 kilograms of sorghum whereas a day's wage in Wau buys around 10 kilograms of sorghum. It is estimated that an average household size of seven needs approximately four kilograms of cereal per day to meet their basic food needs, though it is unlikely most households are accessing labor opportunities daily.

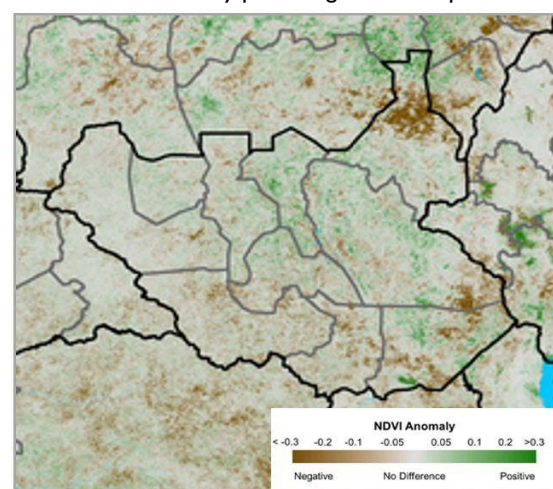
Overall, the above-mentioned drivers of acute food insecurity in South Sudan remain similar to last year. Conflict has reduced in some areas; however, given the significant negative impact of years of conflict on households' livelihoods and capacity to cope, many continue to face difficulty accessing sufficient food to meet their basic needs. Data on food consumption from FSNMS 23

Figure 3. Conflict density, Oct.1, 2018-Feb. 15, 2019



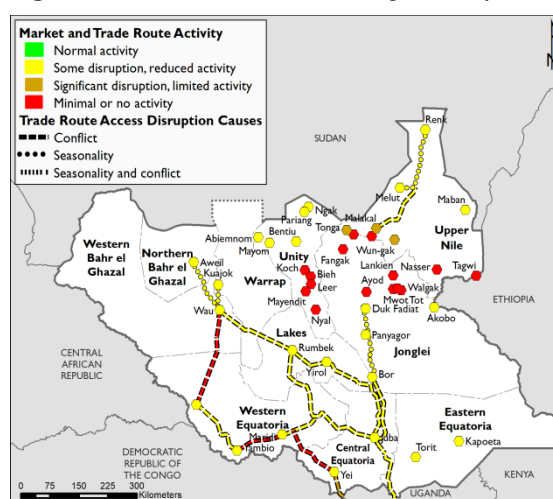
Source: ACLED data

Figure 4. Normalized Difference Vegetation Index (NDVI) conditions immediately preceding harvest, September 2018



Source: USGS/FEWS NET

Figure 5. Market and trade functioning, February 2019



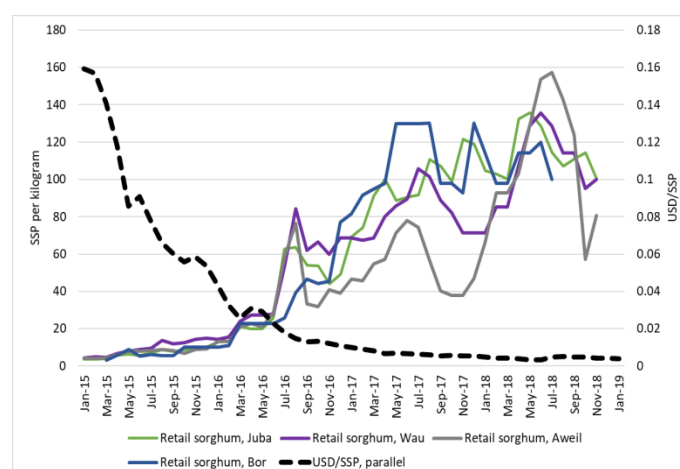
Source: FEWS NET

indicate that extreme levels of acute food insecurity persist during the post-harvest period. Compared to January 2018, the percent of households nationally reporting a poor Food Consumption Score (FCS) declined from 63 percent in January 2018 to 51 percent in January 2019, with county-level trends varying across the country (Figure 7). The percentage of the population who reported severe hunger on the Household Hunger Scale (HHS), indicative of Emergency (IPC Phase 4) or Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5), declined from 6 percent in January 2018 to 4 percent in January 2019, with relative improvement in Jonglei and southern UNS, though deterioration in other areas (Figure 8). However, the reporting of moderate hunger increased from 54 to 61 percent over the same time period, greater than the decline in severe hunger. Additionally, an estimated 50 percent of the population reported currently engaging in at least one coping strategy indicative of Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or Emergency (IPC Phase 4) due to a lack of food or money to purchase food. Overall, it is expected food security outcomes have remained somewhat similar to last year, indicative of widespread Crisis (IPC Phase 3) and Emergency (IPC Phase 4), with some households in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5).

Humanitarian food assistance continues to reduce the severity and scale of acute food insecurity. An estimated 1.5 million people a month were reached with assistance through GFD and FFA with, on average, a 50 percent ration. The majority of assistance has been distributed to Greater Upper Nile and areas of high concern in Greater Bahr el Ghazal.

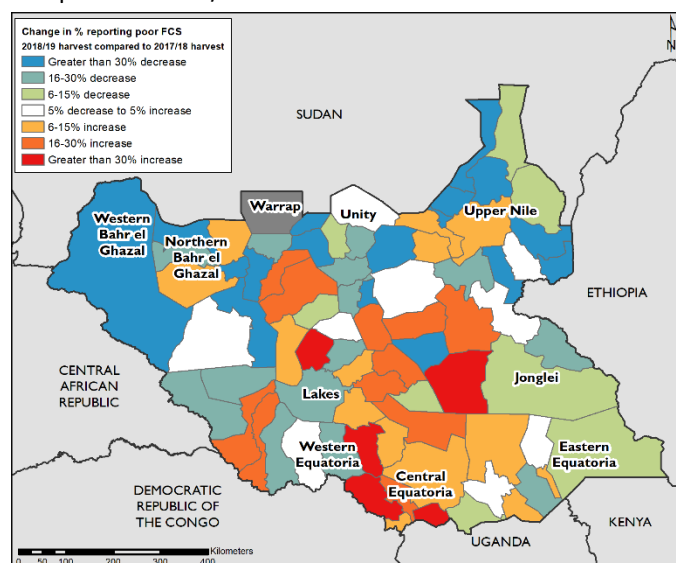
According to nutrition data from 23 SMART Surveys collected between September and December 2018, the level of acute malnutrition varies across the country and indicates slight improvement when compared with SMART surveys from the same months in 2017: the median Global Acute Malnutrition (GAM) prevalence as measured by weight-for-height z-score (WHZ) was 10.1 percent, down from 14.1 percent. Of the 23 counties surveyed between September and December 2018, the GAM prevalence was 'Alert' (GAM (WHZ) 5.0-9.9%) in nine counties, indicative of Stressed (IPC Phase 2), 'Serious' (10.0-14.9%) in nine counties, indicative of Crisis (IPC Phase 3), and 'Critical' (GAM (WHZ) 15-29.9%) in four counties, indicative of Emergency (IPC Phase 4). Nutrition data from FSNMS 23 also indicated some improvement relative to last year. In part this is attributed to improved access nutrition and health services in some of the areas, including Unity and Jonglei.

Figure 6. Retail price of sorghum in key markets versus USD/SSP exchange rate on the parallel market



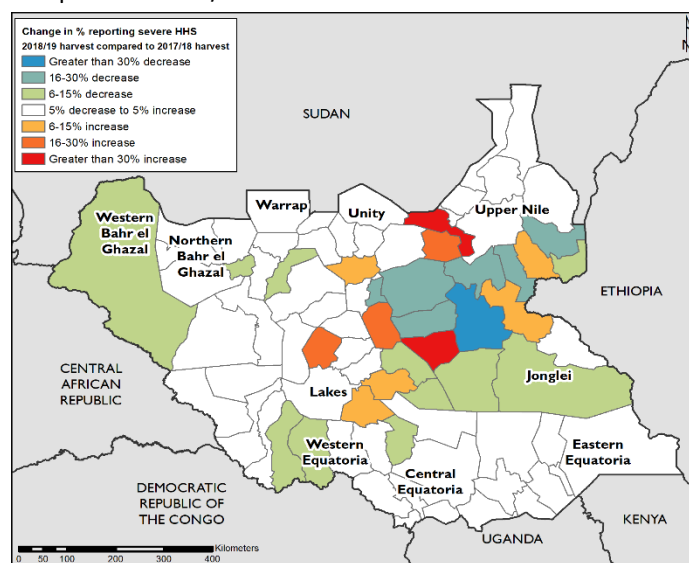
Source: WFP data

Figure 7. Change in reporting of poor FCS, 2018/19 harvest compared to 2017/18 harvest



Source: FSNMS Rounds 21 and 23 data

Figure 8. Change in reporting of severe HHS, 2018/19 harvest compared to 2017/18 harvest



Source: FSNMS Rounds 21 and 23 data

Despite improved food access during the current post-harvest season relative to the lean season, Crisis (IPC Phase 3) and Emergency (IPC Phase 4) persist, and assistance is preventing worse outcomes in several northern areas. Areas of greatest concern include Upper Nile (UNS), Jonglei, and Lakes, specifically Panyikang of UNS, Pigi/Canal and Pibor of Jonglei, and Cueibet of Lakes where it is expected some households are in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5). Central Unity also remains of concern, though HFA has driven notable improvements relative to late 2018 and Crisis (IPC Phase 3) exist. Western Bahr el Ghazal also remains of concern, and in Raja, Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes persist while in Wau, Emergency (IPC Phase 4) exists. In addition, Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes exist in Kapoeta East and Kapoeta North of Eastern Equatoria due to high food prices and low access to livestock products. In Yei of Central Equatoria, Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes are due to the ongoing conflict that is displacing households and limiting access to harvests and markets. This was confirmed by a rapid assessment conducted by FEWS NET in late February in Yei Town which indicated significant disruption to markets and trade.

Assumptions

The February to September 2019 most likely scenario is based on the following national-level assumptions:

- Conflict is expected to continue; however, the number of conflict incidents is expected to be similar to current levels, which are lower than levels observed from 2016 to mid-2018.
- In view of expected continued conflict, some people will be newly displaced both internally and [to neighboring countries](#), though new displacements are likely to be lower than trends in 2016-2018. Given the establishment of cantonment areas, joint monitoring of the cessation of hostilities, and confidence building, it is likely some IDPs will return to their places of origin, though the number will likely not be large-scale.
- Based on forecasts from NOAA and USGS, above-average March to May rainfall is forecast in Greater Equatoria. Accordingly to historical Climate Hazards Group InfraRed Precipitation with Station Data (CHIRPS) from 2000-2018, the median and average rainfall amounts in Western and Central Equatoria are between 1,100 and 1,300 mm. In Eastern Equatoria, average and median rainfall amounts are typically around 850 mm. Based on the forecast for above-average rainfall, higher totals than the above-mentioned totals are expected in these areas.
- The June to September main rainy season in Greater Bahr el Ghazal and Greater Upper Nile is also forecast to be above average and based on historical rainfall data it is expected rainfall totals will be above the 700-1,100 mm that is typical across northern areas of the country. Flooding is likely in low-lying areas along the Nile River and its tributaries.
- The availability of fish and wild foods will decline seasonally through March. Availability will increase during the rainy season in March/April in Greater Equatoria and May/June in northern areas, and fish availability will likely be above-average given likely flooding. However, periodic conflict will limit some households access to these food sources.
- Many households are likely to plant first-season crops in Greater Equatoria in March/April and May/June in northern areas, though some will lack productive assets and be unable to plant. Overall it is expected the area planted in 2019 will be slightly higher than 2018 as some displaced households are expected to return to their places of origin to plant and conflict is likely to be relatively lower than in recent years. However, planting is only expected to be slightly higher given that many households, including returnees, are still expected to lack adequate productive assets and, in some places, insecurity will limit access to farmland. Overall, first season production is expected to be similar to, or slightly

Figure 9. Global Acute Malnutrition (GAM) results by weight-for-height z-score (WHZ) from SMART surveys conducted during the harvest season, Sept-Dec. 2018 versus Sept-Dec 2017

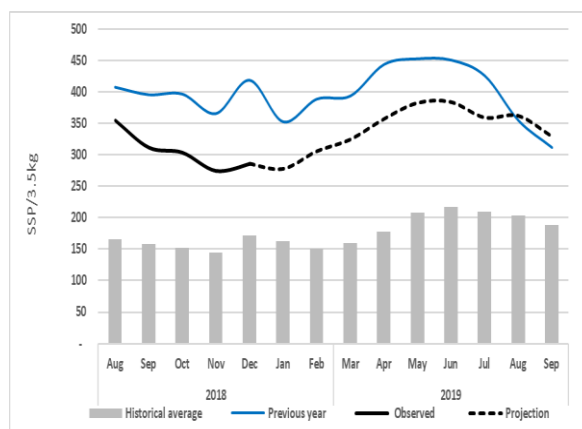
County	GAM (WHZ) Sept. – Dec.2018	GAM (WHZ) Sept. – Dec. 2017
Maiwut	10.0% (7.3-13.7)	N/A
Ibba	6.9% (5.4-8.9)	N/A
Longochuck	12.0% (9.2-15.6)	26.8% (22.8-31.2)
Mvolo	8.6% (5.9-12.5)	11.5% (8.8-14.9)
Twic	24.1% (20.3-28.5)	N/A
Terekeka	5.1% (3.6-7.3)	12.7% (9.9-16.2)
Kapoeta North	8.1% (5.7-11.3)	N/A
Kapoeta South	8.5% (6.1-11.8)	N/A
Kapoeta East	11.7% (8.6-15.8)	24.0% (19.0-29.8)
Yambio	2.3% (1.3-4.1)	N/A
Pibor	20.8% (17.3-24.8)	26.8% (22.8-31.2)
Fangak	14.2% (10.9-18.2)	N/A
Tonj East	9.3% (7.4-11.7)	N/A
Ikotos	13.5% (10.6-17.2)	10.3% (7.9-13.3)
Raja	5.4% (3.5-8.3)	7.3% (5.3-10.1)
Ulang	11.1% (7.7-15.5)	N/A
Maridi	5.5% (3.9-7.7)	N/A
Rumbek North	10.1% (7.5-13.5)	N/A
Awerial	15.2% (12.3-18.6)	N/A
Torit	9.4% (6.5-13.2)	N/A
Aweil North	12.6% (10.1-15.5)	18.5% (14.4-23.3)
Aweil West	12.5% (10.4-14.9)	14.6% (11.0-19.2)
Panyijiar	15.6% (11.6-20.7)	13.2% (10.1-17.2)

Source: South Sudan Nutrition Information Working Group/UNICEF

Above, last year. Flooding is likely to cause some crop losses.

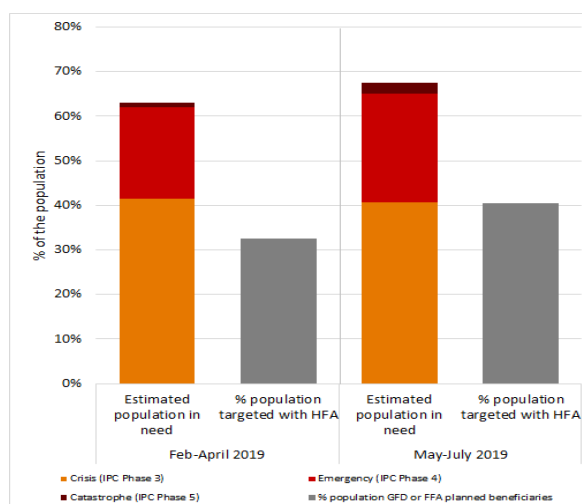
- Based on FEWS NET's integrated price projections Juba, Wau, and Aweil, it is expected that staple food prices in Juba in 2019 will be lower than 2018 prices, around 65-90 SSP/kg, but remain significantly higher than pre-crisis levels and the five-year average (Figure 10). In Wau and Aweil, prices will likely to be higher than 2018, driven by continued high transportation costs and intermittent disruptions to trade flows. In these markets, the retail price of sorghum is expected to be between 100 and 145 SSP/kg.
- Trade and market functioning are likely to improve relative to last year given likely lower conflict, though in areas where insecurity will persist, trade flows will be intermittently disrupted. Imports from Uganda will likely increase relative to recent years, as demand is expected to increase with the return of some households and given the expectation of trader confidence in improved security. Imports from Sudan will likely remain similar to, or slightly lower than, 2018 given the worsening of macroeconomic situation in Sudan.
- Macroeconomic conditions are expected to remain very poor; however, slight improvement, or at a minimum stability, is expected due primarily to increases in oil production. Currently production is at 165,000 barrels per day and there are plans for increased oil production in Unity and Upper Nile, as well as the opening of new oil fields due to reduced conflict. As a result, oil production is expected to be higher in 2019 than in 2018 and this is expected to help slow depreciation of the SSP. It is expected the exchange rate will fluctuate between 250 and 300 SSP/USD.
- WFP plans to reach 3-4 million people monthly between February and July through GFD and FFA, with a 50 percent ration on average. The most likely scenario assumes assistance according to these plans as they are the most up-to-date available, though all 2019 distribution plans are currently under review and there may be revisions to the size and location of distributions. Based on past trends, it is expected that the reach of assistance will be somewhat lower than the 3-4 million planned, around 2.5-3 million per month, based on periodic access and budgetary constraints. Also based on past planning and funding trends, it is expected that assistance delivery will continue through September, though at lower levels than given through July.

Figure 10. Projected retail price of white sorghum, Juba



Source: FEWS NET projection based on WFP data

Figure 11. Projected population in need of humanitarian food assistance (HFA) during the Feb-July 2019 lean season versus estimated population expected to receive HFA



Source: [South Sudan IPC technical release](#); WFP Operation Plan

Most Likely Food Security Outcomes

Food security is expected to deteriorate in many counties throughout the projection period. Between February and May, many households are expected to face food consumption gaps as they deplete harvests. Fish and wild foods will be one of the primary food sources for many, though conflict will periodically disrupt access. Furthermore, high prices and low market supplies in some areas will continue to limit households' capacity to purchase sufficient food. In pastoral livelihood zones of Eastern Equatoria and southern Jonglei, this time period will represent the peak of hunger as livestock will still be seasonally away from homesteads, limiting access to milk and livestock sales for some household members who remain at homesteads. Crisis (IPC Phase 3) and Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are expected in many counties, and some households in areas of greatest concern will likely be in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5).

Food security is expected to deteriorate further through the peak of the lean season in July/August. Food availability and access, outside of assistance, is lowest during this period and many households will face large consumption gaps. The

prevalence of acute malnutrition is expected to deteriorate to ‘Serious’ or ‘Critical’ levels in many areas, and widespread Crisis (IPC Phase 3) and Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are likely, and Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) outcomes are still expected. Areas of the greatest concern including Panyikang of UNS, Canal/Pigi, Akobo, and Pibor of Jonglei, and Cueibet, Rumbek North, and Yirol East of Lakes. Central Unity and Western Bahr el Ghazal also remain areas of high concern.

Although food assistance is planned and likely, planned levels are significantly lower than that needed to meet the need (Figure 11) and past trends indicated that food security deteriorates during the lean season even though assistance scales up during this time. It is expected that during this time an estimated 7.7 million people will be in need of food assistance during the peak of the lean season. Food security will begin to improve somewhat towards the end of the projection period with the 2019/20 harvest, though a risk of Famine (IPC Phase 5) will persist throughout the projection period.

AREAS OF CONCERN

Panyikang of Upper Nile State; Pigi/Canal, Pibor, and Akobo of Jonglei (Figure 10)

Current Situation

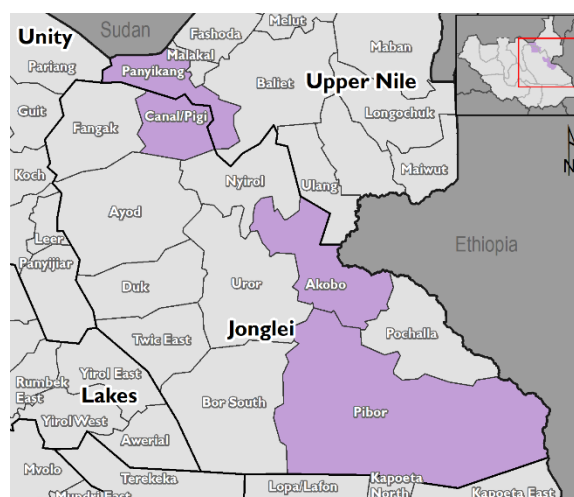
In Canal/Pigi of Jonglei and neighboring Panyikang of Upper Nile, inter-communal conflict, cattle raiding, low cereal production, and extremely high food prices are driving extreme acute food insecurity. In Canal/Pigi, the number of IDPs increased from 6,423 in April 2018 to 13,466 in December. In Panyikang, an estimated 12,028 people were displaced by the end of 2018, though many had fled to Sudan in 2018 and preceding years. In both counties, households reported numerous ongoing shocks. In Canal/Pigi, 71 percent reported a decrease in their income in the past six months and 55 percent reported unusually high food prices. In Panyikang, 38 percent reported a decrease in household income.

Pibor and Akobo also remain of high concern. In Pibor, 46 percent of households reported insecurity as a shock experienced in the past six months, and 40 percent reported unusually high food prices. Conflict in Nyirol, Uror, and Akobo West drove large-scale displacement to Akobo in late 2018, increasing the number of IDPs in the county from 6,568 in April to 90,211 by October, though several thousand returned home and the estimate is now around 68,824 people. Many IDPs lost key livelihood assets while fleeing and no longer have the same access to typical sources of food, and the increased population putting stress on available food sources within the county. Similar to Canal/Pigi and Panyikang, the combination of low food availability in markets, high food prices, and low crop production has resulted in very low food access for many households.

Preliminary data from the 2018/19 CFSAM indicates that own crop production was low in the counties of concern. In Canal/Pigi, 467 MT of cereals were produced, significantly lower than the total cereal requirement of 11,175 MT, and lower than pre-crisis production levels of around 4,000 MT. In Panyikang, production was estimated at 1,870 MT, somewhat lower than production in previous years which was over 2,000 MT. In Akobo, production was estimated at 4,492 MT, similar to last year but below pre-crisis levels of around 5,800 MT. In Pibor, production was estimated at 2,454 MT, similar to recent years but lower than pre-crisis levels of over 3,000 MT.

In all the counties of concern, markets are operating at minimal levels due to insecurity-related disruptions and poor road infrastructure connecting the counties of concern to the supplying markets. In Panyikang, the only functioning market is in Tonga, though insecurity continues to intermittently limit household access and many households in rural payams do not have physical access as the walk would take over 6 hours. Only 3 percent of households reported accessing cereals from the market. In Canal/Pigi, none of the surveyed households reported obtaining cereals from markets. In Akobo, markets are functional, supplied by goods from the Ethiopia, and 30 percent of the households are accessing their cereals from the markets. In Pibor, key informants report that trade flows from Juba are intermittently insecure, driving high prices: a kilogram of brown sorghum in Pibor costs roughly 130 SSP, 33 percent higher than the cost in Juba.

Figure 10. Area of concern reference map, Canal/Pigi, Akobo, and Pibor of Jonglei and Panyikang of Upper Nile



Source: FEWS NET

Livestock products are typically an important source of food and income for households in the counties of concern, though herd sizes have significantly declined from pre-crisis levels in Panyikang, Akobo, and Pigi/Canal. According to FSNMS data, the percentage of households reporting owning livestock declined to 2.8 percent in Canal/Pigi from 89.5 percent prior to the outbreak of conflict in 2013. Over the same time period, the reporting of livestock ownership declined from 50.9 percent to 0.9 percent in Panyikang and from 62 percent to 49 percent in Akobo. Even among those who own livestock, access to milk and meat is seasonally low as most livestock are away in dry season grazing areas.

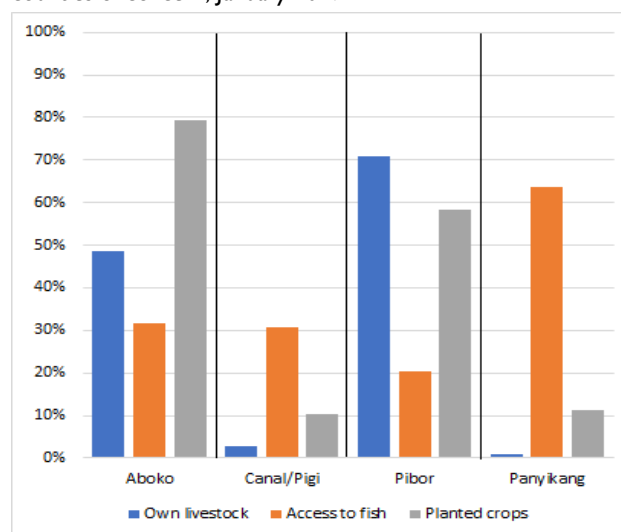
Fishing and wild foods are typically a key source of food and income for many households in these counties; however, conflict has significantly disrupted regular access to these food sources. In Canal/Pigi, only 30 percent of households have access to fishing as a livelihood activity. In Panyikang, fish is readily available, and 60 percent of households reported access to fish, though insecurity still limits access along the Nile River. In Akobo, 31 percent of households reported access to fish and in Pibor, only 20 percent (Figure 11). Only 7 percent of households reported actively gathering wild food in Akobo, and no household in Canal/Pigi or Panyikang reported this, likely due to continued insecurity limiting access to areas where wild foods commonly grow.

Data collected during the FSNMS indicated widespread Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse outcomes (Figure 12). In Canal/Pigi, 75 percent of households reported poor FCS and 20 percent reported Severe HHS, indicating area-level Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes with 12 percent of households reporting an HHS indicative of Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5). In Panyikang, 83 percent of households have a poor FCS and 33 percent reported severe HHS, also indicative of area-level Emergency (IPC Phase 4) with 13 percent of whom reported an HHS indicative of Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5). Additional data indicated that household who reported an HHS indicative of Catastrophe also reported little or no livestock ownership and are consuming cereal 2 or fewer days a week. In Akobo, 52 percent of households reported poor FCS and 80 percent reported moderate HHS, indicative of area-level Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or Emergency (IPC Phase 4); 5 percent reported Severe HHS indicative of Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5). In Pibor, 43 percent of households have a poor FCS and 75 percent reported a moderate hunger, also indicative of area-level Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or Emergency (IPC Phase 4); 3 percent reported severe hunger indicative of Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5).

According to nutrition data from FSNMS, the GAM (WHZ) prevalence in Canal/Pigi was 15.4 percent, indicative of Emergency (IPC Phase 4), while in Panyikang the GAM (WHZ) was 13.5 percent, indicative of Crisis (IPC Phase 3). In Akobo East, also from FSNMS nutrition data, the GAM (WHZ) prevalence was 25.9 percent, indicative of Emergency (IPC Phase 4). In Pibor, a GAM prevalence from a SMART survey was 20.8 percent (17.3-24.8), also indicative of Emergency (IPC Phase 4).

According to household reporting to FSNMS, 34 percent of households in Akobo reported receiving HFA in the past 30 days, whereas less than 5 percent reported receiving HFA in the past 30 days in Akobo, Pibor, and Pigi/Canal. The distribution of HFA between October and December according to WFP distribution reports is similar, stating around 25 percent of the population was reached with a half ration in Akobo and 5 percent of the population was reached in Pigi/Canal. In Panyikang, WFP distribution data indicates significant assistance delivered in November, though this likely falls outside of the 30-day recall period of FSNMS data collection. Assistance in Panyikang is mostly likely reaching households living in and

Figure 11. Reporting of access to key sources of food in counties of concern, January 2019



Source: FSNMS data

Figure 12. Food consumption outcomes in Akobo, Pigi/Canal, Pibor, and Panyikang, January 2019

	Food Consumption Score	Household Hunger Scale	Reduced Coping Strategies Index
Akobo	29% Borderline; 52% Poor	80% Moderate; 16% Severe (5% HHS 5-6)	33% rCSI>18
Canal/Pigi	15% Borderline; 75% Poor	78% Moderate; 20% Severe (12% HHS 5-6)	36% rCSI>18
Pibor	11% Borderline; 43% Poor	75% Moderate; 3% Severe (3% HHS 5-6)	32% rCSI>18
Panyikang	16% Borderline; 83% Poor	66% Moderate; 20% Severe (13% HHS 5-6)	21% rCSI>18

Source: FSNMS data

around Tonga, while it is less likely those in rural areas are being reached. January distribution data indicates large-scale assistance continued to an estimated 20 percent of the population, though no general food distribution was delivered in January in Pibor, Canal/Pigi, or Panyikang.

Based on the above outcomes, it is expected that ongoing HFA is preventing worse outcomes in Akobo and this county is in Crisis (IPC Phase 3!). Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are expected in Pibor, Pigi/Canal, and Panyikang, and it is expected that some households are in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) in these three counties. In Pibor, although the percentage of the population reporting Catastrophe outcomes was under five percent when the data was collected in December/January, it is likely outcomes have deteriorated given that food insecurity deteriorates during the January to April dry season.

Assumptions

In addition to the national-level assumptions above, projected outcomes for the counties of concern in Jonglei and Upper Nile states are based on the following assumptions:

- Inter-communal conflict is likely to persist in Akobo and Pibor, leading to loss of lives, livestock theft, and displacement.
- Based on historical rainfall data and the forecast for above-average June to September rainfall, over 925 mm of rainfall is expected throughout the season.
- It is expected most households will have more access to land for cultivation during the 2019/20 agricultural season, and Based on this and relatively lower conflict than previous years, it is expected the land under cultivation will be higher than last year. Agriculture labor opportunities will be seasonally high from February-April but still below average as many households do not have resources to pay for laborers.
- Among households who own livestock, access to livestock products will be seasonally low through May as livestock remain in dry season grazing areas. Access to milk will improve during June to July, but will be below average due to significantly lower livestock holdings.
- Based on an analysis of price data from CLiMIS, the retail price of white sorghum is likely to remain stable through April and increase from May to September, all the while remaining significantly above average. Prices are expected to be highest in Panyikang due to very low production and limited trade flows from Sudan.
- Given the levels of production reported, it is likely most households depleted their food stocks in early February. Households are likely relying heavily on fish, wild foods, and game meat after February. Game meat availability will be normal, but seasonally decline during the rainy season as game animal move away from homesteads during this time.
- Between March and July, WFP plans to distribute a 30 percent ration to an estimated 50 percent of the population in Akobo and roughly 18 percent of the population with roughly a 50 percent ration monthly. It is anticipated this assistance in these counties will reach the target beneficiaries given some relative calm and past trends. In Canal/Pigi, WFP plans to reach roughly 40 percent of the population in Pigi/Canal and 65 percent of the population in Panyikang, both with a 25 percent monthly ration. However, in Canal/Pigi and Panyikang, the distribution of assistance is likely to be inconsistent given continued insecurity and based on past distribution trends where distribution are irregular during the rainy season. Based on past trends, assistance is expected to continue through September, though at somewhat lower levels than those planned through July.

Most Likely Food Security Outcomes

Food security is anticipated to deteriorate through May and some households are expected to face large consumption gaps in all the counties of concern as household cereal stocks dwindle, access to natural foods are seasonally low and at times disrupted due to conflict, and livestock are still away from homesteads. Many households are expected to continue to lack physical access to markets or sufficient income to purchase adequate cereal needs. Given the level of HFA planned for Akobo and the livelihood that it will be delivered during this time period, Crisis (IPC Phase 3!) outcomes are expected to continue, with HFA preventing more extreme outcomes. Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are expected to persist in Canal/Pigi and Pibor of Jonglei and Panyikang of Upper Nile, and some households are expected to be in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5). This population includes households who lack livestock, did not harvest, and face difficulty with regularly accessing wild foods and fish.

Food security is expected to further deteriorate in Panyikang and Pigi/Canal through August, though improvement is expected in September with the green harvest. It is likely that many households will rely heavily on the consumption of wild foods, fishing, and game meat where available. Although many livestock will begin returning from dry season grazing areas, overall ownership is expected to remain very low, especially in Pigi/Canal and Panyikang, and overall access to milk will remain negligible for many households. Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes will persist in Canal/Pigi and Panyikang. The population in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) is expected to increase during this time. In Akobo, for the same reasons mentioned above, Crisis (IPC Phase 3!) outcomes are expected to persist. In Pibor, April/May is the peak of the lean season and food security outcomes are expected to improve after May; through September Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes are likely

AREAS OF CONCERN

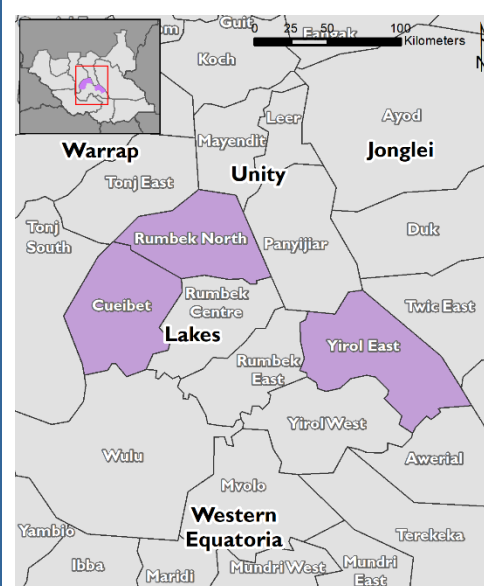
Lakes State: Cueibet, Rumbek North, and Yirol East

Current Situation

In Rumbek North, Yirol East, and Cueibet, the key drivers of acute food insecurity are protracted conflict and erratic rainfall during the 2018/19 season. Based on FSNMS results, 67 percent of households in Rumbek North, 43 percent in Yirol East, and 52 percent in Cueibet reported insecurity that has resulted in a loss of income in the past six months. This was further collaborated by [REACH Area of knowledge assessment](#) conducted in Eastern Lakes in September 2018 that indicated lack of rains and conflict-related displacement were drivers of inadequate access to food. This conflict has repeatedly disrupted livelihoods and led to large-scale displacement: 11,905 people remain displaced in Rumbek North, 37,290 people in Yirol East, and 8,869 people in Cueibet.

Based on satellite rainfall estimates, rains started early in all the counties of concern, between late March and early April; however, there was a prolonged dry spell between June and August, a critical time for crop growth. Although 90 to 98 percent of the households in these areas of concern reported access to land for cultivation, the dry spell led to crop losses. Based on preliminary results from CFSAM, the state-level deficit climbed to 23,285 MT in 2019, up from 22,459 MT in 2018. CFSAM, the state-level deficit climbed to 23,285 MT in 2019, up from 22,459 MT in 2018. Conversely, Cueibet registered a cereal surplus of 68 MT in 2018/19, down from a surplus of 4,201 MT in 2017/2018. In addition to the dry spell and conflict-related disruptions, households reported pests and disease infestation and shortage of agriculture inputs as negatively impacting production. In Rumbek North, cereal deficits have persisted during the last four years, and the deficit increased to 2,710 MT in 2018/19.

Figure 13. Area of concern reference map, Cueibet, Rumbek North, and Yirol East of Lakes



Source: FEWS NET

Also according to data from FSNMS, households in the three areas of concern reported below average harvest. Roughly 50 - 60 percent of households in Rumbek North, Yirol East, and Cueibet reported stock lasting for 1 to 2 months. This is further corroborated by a recent rapid assessment conducted by FEWS NET in mid-February in Maloupec and Citock payams of Cueibet that indicated some households had already depleted their stocks. In a typical year, the majority of households produce 6 to 8 months worth of food stocks. Given that more than 90 percent of households in these county are primarily subsistence farmers depending on rainfed agriculture for food and income, conflict-related displacement and the prolonged dry spell have significantly impact food access.

Analysis of FSNMS 23 data indicates that about 67.8 percent households in Rumbek North reported livestock ownership, down from 76.9 percent before the 2013 crisis. Conversely, livestock ownership increased in Yirol East and Cueibet, from 37.8 percent to 65.7 percent in Yirol East and from 26.6 percent to 66.7 percent in Cueibet. [Cattle-raiding and counter-raiding from neighboring communities](#) persists and contributes the changes in herd sizes.

Rumbek central market is the main supply source for all the rural markets in the three counties of concern. The markets in

these counties are operational but seasonally restricted. Despite the harvest and improved security along the trade route, the price of staple food commodities remains very high: the retail price of sorghum in Rumbek Centre is 562 percent higher than the five-year average and 125 percent higher than the same time last year. With reduced incomes, households are facing difficulty accessing adequate amounts of foods from the market.

Based on FSNMS data, 50 percent households in Yirol East reported a poor FCS and 88 percent reported moderate HHS, indicative of area-level Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes, with 4 percent

reporting severe hunger indicative of Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5). In Cueibet, 91 percent households reported poor FCS and 26 percent reported severe hunger, indicative of area-level Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes with 10 percent reporting severe hunger indicative of Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5). In Rumbek North, 50 percent of households reported poor FCS and 88 percent reporting moderate HHS, indicative of area-level Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes. In all of the counties of concern, under 10 percent of households are currently engaged in Emergency (IPC Phase 4) coping strategies, though a high percentage of the population is engaged in one or more Crisis (IPC Phase 3) strategies. An analysis of the reporting of these indicators at the household level indicates that most households in these areas are in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) and Emergency (IPC Phase 4), with outcomes being most severe in Cueibet.

Nutrition data collected during the FSNMS R23 conducted between October and December 2018 in Cueibet, Rumbek North, and Yirol East reported a GAM (WHZ) prevalence at a 'Serious' level, indicative of Crisis (IPC Phase 3). In Cueibet the GAM (WHZ) was 10.7 percent, in Rumbek North it was 10.1 percent (7.5-13.5), and in Yirol East it was 12.9 percent.

The delivery of HFA was very minimal in all the areas of concern in recent months. Based on both WFP distribution reports for October to December 2018 and FSNMS 23 survey conducted in December 2018, less than 10 percent of the population was reached by food assistance during their respective time periods.

It is expected that most households are relying on some crops and wild foods, as well as milk and fish for those who have access. Although many households in these counties do own livestock, it is expected the most food insecure do not: among households who reported severe hunger (HHS 4-6), only 50 percent in Rumbek North reported access to milk, 10 percent in Cueibet, and 0 percent in Yirol East. Based on the above outcomes and contributing factors, it is expected Rumbek North is in Crisis (IPC Phase 3), Yirol East is in Emergency (IPC Phase 4), and Cueibet is in Emergency (IPC Phase 4) with some households in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5).

Assumptions

- Inter-communal conflict is expected to increase between February and May as herders compete for the dry season pastures and water, and this will likely result in the loss of some lives and livestock.
- Trade and market functioning are likely to improve slightly throughout the state, though in areas of concern where inter-communal conflict and cattle-raiding will persist, trade flows will be intermittently disrupted. Additionally, based on the forecast of above-average rainfall, feeder road conditions and physical access to markets during the projection period is expected to be seasonally worse than normal. Staple foods are likely to follow seasonal trends, but to be above last year and five-year averages based on FEWS NET's integrated price projections.
- Between March and July, WFP plans to reach nearly 100 percent of the population in Rumbek North, 24 percent of the population in Cueibet, and 8 percent of the population in Yirol East, with between a 30 and 50 percent ration. Based on past trends, assistance is expected to continue through September, though at somewhat lower levels than those planned through July. It is not expected that conflict will significantly disrupt the delivery of assistance, though assistance delivery is likely to be inconsistent during the rainy season.

Figure 13. Food consumption outcomes, Cueibet, Rumbek North, and Yirol East, January 2019

	Food Consumption Score	Household Hunger Scale	Reduced Coping Strategies Index
Cueibet	6% Borderline; 91% Poor	69% Moderate; 26% Severe (10% HHS 5-6)	91% rCSI 4-18 9% rCSI>18
Rumbek North	39% Borderline; 49% Poor	88% Moderate; 4% Severe (1% HHS 5-6)	97% rCSI 4-18 3% rCSI>18
Yirol East	7% Borderline; 84% Poor	88% Moderate; 4% Severe (4% HHS 5-6)	82% rCSI 4-18 16% rCSI>18

Source: FSNMS Round 23 data

Most Likely Food Security Outcomes

Food security is expected to deteriorate through September as household stocks start to deplete and access to livestock products is seasonally low. Furthermore, households will face very high staple food prices. Although improvements in security, if sustained, are expected to lead to food security improvements over the long term, widespread acute food insecurity is expected to persist given that many households are already engaging in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or Emergency (IPC Phase 4) coping to meet their basic food needs and not all households have livestock or access to harvests. Increased fish will mitigate food consumption gaps for some though. Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are expected in Yirol East and Cueibet and Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) populations are likely in Cueibet. In Rumbek North, where planned assistance is quite high, Crisis (IPC Phase 3!) outcomes are expected to persist though some households are still likely to be in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5). In these counties with expected Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) populations, it is expected these are households already reporting food consumption gaps indicative of Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) and those who lack livestock and harvests and for whom no or minimal improvements in food access are likely during the projection period.

OTHER AREAS OF CONCERN

Unity State: Leer, Mayendit, and Koch

Current Situation

Heavy conflict between April and June 2018 in Leer and Mayendit led to death, large-scale displacement, the prolonged absence of HFA, and disruption to livelihoods that resulted in a significant deterioration in food security outcomes. In August 2018, FSNMS data was collected as conflict had somewhat declined and humanitarians were able to again access the area, though food assistance had not yet reached many households of greatest concern. Data indicated upwards of 20 percent of the population could be in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5), though available evidence on nutrition and mortality suggested that these indicators had not neared the Famine (IPC Phase 5) thresholds. In Koch, where the impact of conflict was less severe, Crisis (IPC Phase 3!) outcomes existed.

Since then, conflict has remained low, with the exception of occasional cattle-raiding. This has fostered greater household movement and engagement in some level of typical livelihood activities, albeit to a much more restricted degree than pre crisis. HFA deliveries have continued and has likely prevented further deterioration through mid and late 2018 (Figure 14). According to FSNMS data, 93 percent of households in Leer, 26 percent of households in Koch, and 80 percent of households in Mayendit reported receiving HFA in the past month.

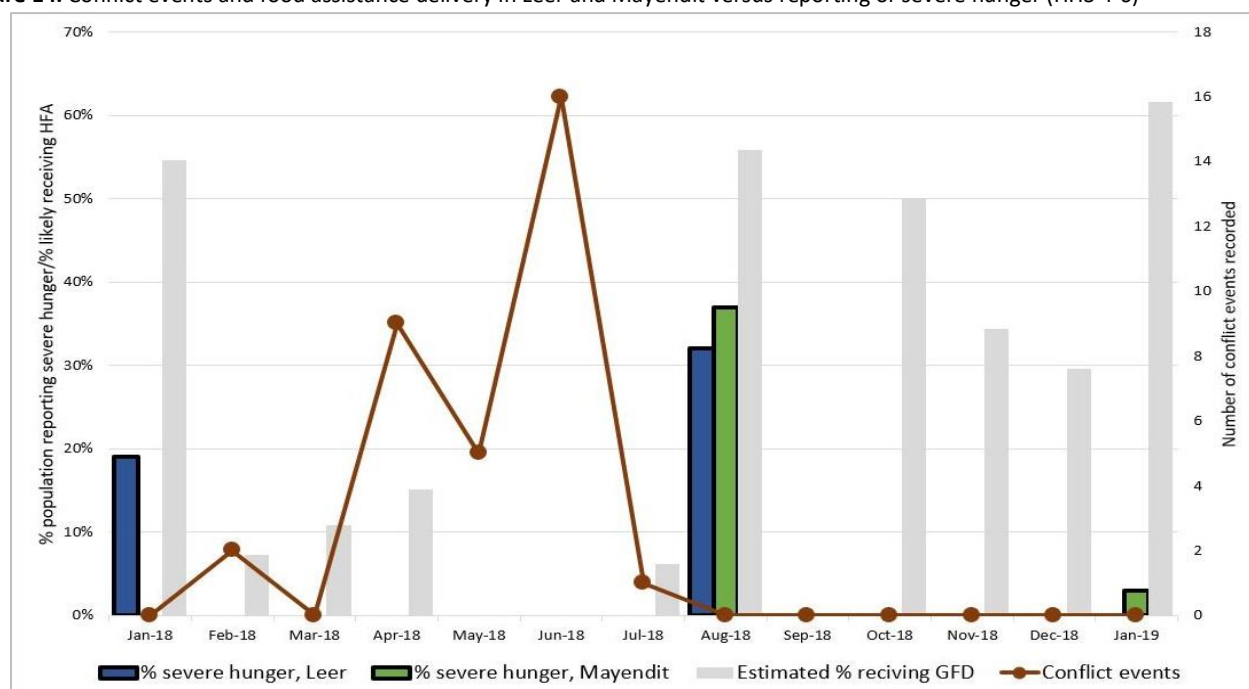
Despite the reduction in conflict in the latter half of 2018, the violence impacted the 2018 cultivation season and as such production is very low. In Mayendit and Leer, production declined by 5 percent between 2018 and 2019, though production in 2018 was already extremely low compared to needs and pre-crisis levels. In Koch, production declined by 10.3 percent. As a result of increased cereal gaps, households have increased dependence on other food sources including fish, wild foods, and assistance. Physical access to a functioning market has increased since some traders have started returning to the markets in Leer and northern Mayendit; however, prices are still high and limiting households from purchasing sufficient food. Data from FSNMS indicates that only 1-2 percent of households in these counties are accessing cereals from markets. In Koch, 51 percent of households reported owning livestock and 50 percent report access to milk. Though, only 13 percent of households in Leer and 4 percent of households in Mayendit reported owning livestock, and roughly 10 percent reported access to milk for consumption.

Data collected during the 2018/19 post-harvest FSNMS indicated that 28 percent of households in Leer, 73 percent of households in Koch, and 54 percent of households in Mayendit have poor FCS. Although this is indicative of Emergency (IPC Phase 4) per the IPC reference table, it is likely this score is more indicative of a non-diversified diet rather than large food consumption gaps given heavy reliance on assistance and relatively lower reporting of moderate or severe hunger. In Leer, 11 percent reported moderate hunger per the HHS and no households reported severe hunger. In Mayendit 87 percent reported moderate hunger and 3 percent reported severe hunger. In Koch, 61 percent reported moderate hunger and 19 percent reported severe hunger. FEWS NET's household-level convergence of food consumption and livelihood coping data indicate that Mayendit and Leer are likely in Crisis! (IPC Phase 3!). In Koch, where assistance is lower and outcomes are more severe, Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes exist.

The assumptions noted in the national overview are applicable to the areas of concern in Unity State. Based on current

outcomes and those assumptions, food security is expected to deteriorate between February and May as households deplete their food stocks and access to milk and other food sources are seasonally low. Therefore, households are expected to rely heavily on food assistance. Through April, Crisis (IPC Phase 3!) outcomes are likely in Leer and Mayendit given the likely continuation of planned assistance, and Emergency (IPC Phase 4) in Koch. Between June and September, further deterioration in food security outcomes is expected as households completely exhausted their food stocks, and majority do not have livestock, and markets access likely to remain limited due to both seasonality and insecurity. Households who still own livestock are expected to increase reliance on livestock products, some fish and wild vegetables. Given that assistance will be relatively lower, Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are expected in all counties. However, given the expectation of some assistance and increase in fish and wild foods, as well as improved outcomes from significant assistance over the past year, Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) outcomes are not expected during this time. However, in a worst-case scenario in which there is a protracted absence of assistance throughout the projection period, outcomes would likely deteriorate sharply such that a large percentage of the population could face Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) as was observed in September 2018.

Figure 14. Conflict events and food assistance delivery in Leer and Mayendit versus reporting of severe hunger (HHS 4-6)



Source: FSNMS Rounds 21-23 data; WFP distribution data; ACLED data

Western Bahr el Ghazal State: Wau and Raja

Current Situation

Conflict incidents were intermittently reported between June and November 2018, but peaked during the September to October harvesting period, causing large-scale displacement and disrupting the long-term sorghum and cassava production. The displaced households from Baggari, Bessilia, and Raga have reportedly fled to the forests south and west of the Bringi-Farajallah-Mboro road and Wau PoCAA. According to OCHA displacement statistics, 96,806 people remained internally displaced in Wau and 18,450 people in Raga by end of December 2018. However, in early 2019, conflict incidents have reduced, allowing physical access to Wau town.

Although 45 percent of households in Wau and 62 percent of households in Raga had access to land for cultivation and planted, it is expected the percentage of households accessing harvests is lower given conflict and weather-related shocks. Around 20-40 percent of households reported a shortage of rains as a main challenge to farming and this was corroborated by a remote-sensing data which indicated a prolonged dry-spell mid-season. CFSAM preliminary findings indicated an increase in cereal deficit from 2018 to 2019 by 10.9 percent in Wau and by 15.4 percent in Raga. According to FSNMS 23

data analysis, 30-35 percent of the surveyed households in both counties reported that their stocks are likely to last 1 to 2 months; most households are likely to deplete the stock by February.

Markets are not fully functional in Raga or Greater Baggari due to prolonged conflict-related disruptions that resulted in low trade flows and fewer traders operating in these markets. Prices remain extremely high and 41 percent and 22 percent of households in Raga and Wau, respectively, reported unusually high food prices as a major shock in the past six months. In addition to high prices, households face difficulty accessing sufficient food given declines in income: 63 percent of households in Wau and 43 percent of households in Raga reported a decrease in their income in the past 6 months.

Humanitarian assistance delivery remained fairly consistent for displaced households in Wau town and surrounding areas, though in Greater Baggari, assistance was only intermittently delivered. Based on analysis of WFP's distribution report, 36 percent of the total population in Wau was reached with humanitarian assistance during October to December period and received a ration that is equivalent to 56 percent of kilocalorie needs, though the majority of assistance was distributed to Wau town and little went to rural areas given continued access constraints. In Raga, an estimated 14 percent of households were reached with humanitarian assistance, with a ration meeting roughly 45 percent of needs.

Based FSNMS 23 results, 66 percent of households in Wau and 44 percent of households in Raga reported poor FCS; this is indicative of Emergency (IPC phase 4) per the IPC reference table, though it is also possible many households have non-diversified diets rather than large food-consumption gaps. In Wau and Raga, 85 percent and 82 percent, respectively, reported moderate hunger, indicative of Crisis (IPC phase 3). Very few households are engaging currently in coping indicative of Emergency (IPC Phase 4). Based on convergence of indicators, Raga is classified in Crisis (IPC Phase 3). The indicators are also indicative of Crisis (IPC Phase 3) in Wau, though based on additional corroborating evidence – specifically the presence of displaced, inaccessible households who are expected to have little access to harvests or markets – it is expected the situation is worse than data indicates and Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are likely.

The assumptions noted in the national overview are also applicable to Wau and Raga of Western Bahr el Ghazal. Based on current outcomes and the most likely assumptions, food security is expected to deteriorate through September as most households have depleted crops and are relying on fish, wild foods, and wild game. Crisis (IPC Phase 3!) and Emergency (IPC phase 4) will persist in Wau and Raga, respectively, and some households are expected to be in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) in Wau, specifically hard to reach households who have been displaced away from typical food and income sources.

EVENTS THAT MIGHT CHANGE THE OUTLOOK

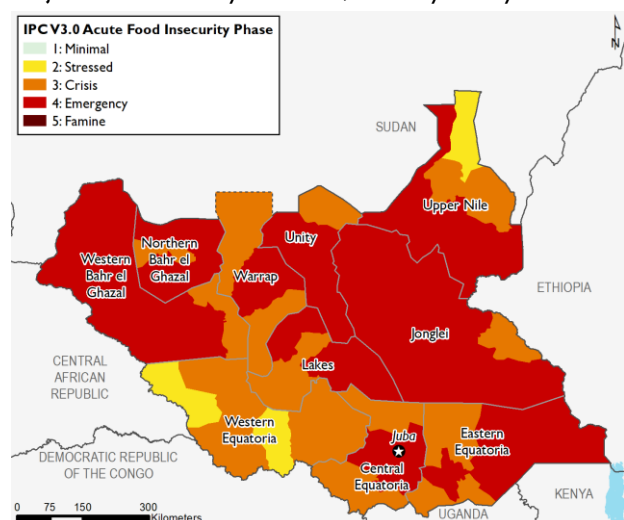
Table I. Possible events over the next eight months that could change the most-likely scenario.

Area	Event	Impact on food security outcomes
National	Prolonged absence of humanitarian food assistance (HFA)	In the prolonged absence of HFA, Emergency (IPC Phase 4) and households in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) would be widespread as depicted in the annex below. When considering the indirect impacts of the absence of humanitarian food assistance, including likely increase in market prices, Famine (IPC Phase 5) would be likely. In addition, increased conflict events could occur over remaining key food sources which would restrict household movement. Considering the current food security outcomes and past conflict trends, areas of greatest concern include Southern Upper Nile, North-eastern Jonglei, Lakes, central and southern Unity, and Western Bahr el Ghazal, and in the event of continued conflict, food security can deteriorate rapidly among populations who face extreme movement restrictions, Famine (IPC Phase 5) remains possible in some areas of the country.

National	Full implementation of the September 2018 peace agreement resulting in significant and sustained decline in conflict	Full implementation of the peace agreement such that there is a significant and sustain decline in conflict would allow households to return to their places of origin and slowly regain their livelihoods. It is expected that the incidence of conflict would decline significantly allowing trade flows and unhindered delivery of humanitarian assistance to households in need. Food insecurity would be less severe and the risk of Famine (IPC Phase 5) would decline.
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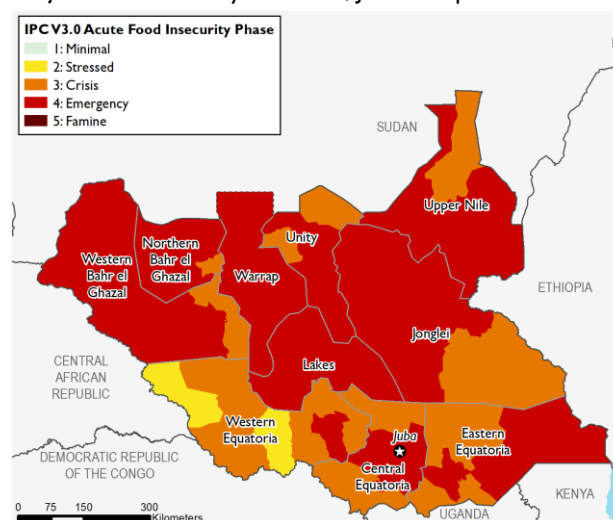
FOOD SECURITY OUTCOMES ASSUMING NO HUMANITARIAN FOOD ASSISTANCE IN THE PROJECTION PERIOD*

Projected food security outcomes, February to May 2019



Source: FEWS NET

Projected food security outcomes, June to September 2019



Source: FEWS NET

FEWS NET classification is IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners.

*Current IPC v3.0 protocols require that a second set of projection maps be created to indicate the most likely food security outcomes in the absence of the anticipated effects of humanitarian food assistance. This protocol is under review and may change.

ABOUT SCENARIO DEVELOPMENT

To project food security outcomes, FEWS NET develops a set of assumptions about likely events, their effects, and the probable responses of various actors. FEWS NET analyzes these assumptions in the context of current conditions and local livelihoods to arrive at a most likely scenario for the coming eight months. [Learn more here.](#)